Was it a blatant act of HR violation or an honest mistake? It is for the senior leadership to see it in the correct perspective. Maybe I was just plain lucky—or was it just destiny?

* * *

Samra

During those days, we used to have some very rudimentary monitoring devices—AR 5000, if I remember correctly. These used to be deployed at various locations and gave out the bearings of any signal intercepts. Theoretically, by triangulation, one should have been able to pinpoint the location of the transmitter and then launch operations based on this signal intelligence, SIGINT, to nab the person doing the transmission. All good in theory, but in practice, the points never intersected but formed a triangle that could be of several square km, with dozens of houses and hundreds of people. One such call sign that used to appear repeatedly was Samra, a Pakistani national of the LeT. The calls would be at any time of the day and week but had one thing in common. The likely triangulated locations always came somewhere near the Battalion HQ, once even within the HQ location itself. Catching this elusive Samra, the local Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT) leader became an obsession. We tried everything from spot searches to pre-positioning undercover search parties who would swoop down on the suspected location the moment the triangulation was received but to no avail. This cat-and-mouse game continued for many months with the GOC, Maj Gen Nirbhay Sharma, breathing down my neck, asking for results. The matter became even more serious when the suspect location was once plotted to be emanating from the K Force HQ itself. Something had to be done!

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